Township of NIPISSING
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REPORT TO COUNCIL

Date: December 2, 2025

From: Kristin Linklater, Deputy Clerk – Administrative Assistant.

Re: 2026 Municipal Election Voting Method.

Report on Voting Methods and Election Practices of Neighbouring Municipalities

Purpose:
The purpose of this report is to provide Council with a summary of election practices, voting methods, and budget considerations from neighbouring municipalities. This information may assist Council in evaluating available voting options and establishing best practices for the 2026 Municipal Election.

1. Township of Bonfield

Voting Method:
Bonfield Council has reaffirmed its commitment to the traditional paper ballot voting method, consistent with previous Municipal Elections.

Budget:
- In 2022, Bonfield spent just under $10,000 on their municipal election.
- The municipality expects to maintain a similar budget for 2026, with no major procedural changes anticipated.

Additional Notes:
All other election related processes are expected to remain unchanged from previous years.

Source: Andrée Gagné, Deputy Clerk-Treasurer, Township of Bonfield

2. Municipality of East Ferris

Voting Method:
East Ferris will continue using paper ballot voting for the 2026 Municipal Election. Although one member of Council proposed changes to the process, the suggestion did not receive majority support. As a result, the Municipality has opted to enhance voter outreach and communication instead of altering its voting method.

Budget:
• East Ferris budgets approximately $18,000 for Municipal Elections.
• The 2026 budget is expected to remain consistent.
• Consolidation of polling stations is anticipated to reduce staffing requirements and associated costs.

Planned Enhancements for 2026:
• Expanded advertising through mass mailouts and social media campaigns.
• A full week of advanced polling to support increased voter turnout.
• Continued in home voting services for vulnerable residents, conducted by the Clerk or Deputy Clerk.

Source: Kim Rose, Acting Clerk, Municipality of East Ferris

3. Township of Nipissing

Voting Method:
The Township of Nipissing has traditionally used paper ballots as its preferred method of voting. For the 2022 Election, the Township offered multiple polling opportunities to ensure broad accessibility and convenience for residents.

Polling Locations and Accessibility:
• Advanced polling stations were held at both the Township Office and the Commanda Community Centre.
• On Election Day, polling stations operated at three locations:
  – Township of Nipissing Community Centre
  – South Shore Education Centre
  – Commanda Community Centre

This multi-location approach ensured that residents across the Township had accessible and convenient options for casting their ballots.

Budget:
• The proposed budget for the 2026 Municipal Election is $12,000.
• In 2022, the Township operated with an Election Budget of $10,000.

The modest increase reflects rising election administration costs while maintaining the Township's commitment to traditional paper ballot voting and accessible polling locations.

The Township has partnered with the City of North Bay and several surrounding municipalities to provide Candidate Training events. Increased education and information will be provided to potential candidates and voters utilizing the Township website, social media and newsletter mailouts to increase voter turnout.

Conclusion:
Across neighbouring municipalities, traditional paper ballot voting remains the preferred and most widely supported method. Budgets for Municipal Elections range between $10,000 and $18,000, with each Municipality tailoring its polling station availability and voter outreach efforts based on community needs.

East Ferris is moving toward enhanced communication and extended advanced voting periods, while Bonfield continues with a stable and consistent approach. The Township of Nipissing maintains a strong focus on accessibility by offering multiple polling locations and modest budget adjustments to support effective Election delivery.

This collective information provides valuable context for local decision making as Council evaluates future Election processes and resource needs for the 2026 Municipal Election.

I only received comment back from Bonfield and East Ferris.
Powassan, Callander and Chisolm were also contacted.

Kristin Linklater, Deputy Clerk, Administrative Assistant.